WNBA DRAFT FIT MODEL

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BACKGROUND INFO

- 3 rounds - 15 picks per round
- 83% WNBA opening day rosters are from the draft
- 74.3% for the NBA



Datasets

- Sports Reference
  - NCAAW (2022 - 2026)
  - WNBA Draft (2019 - 2024)

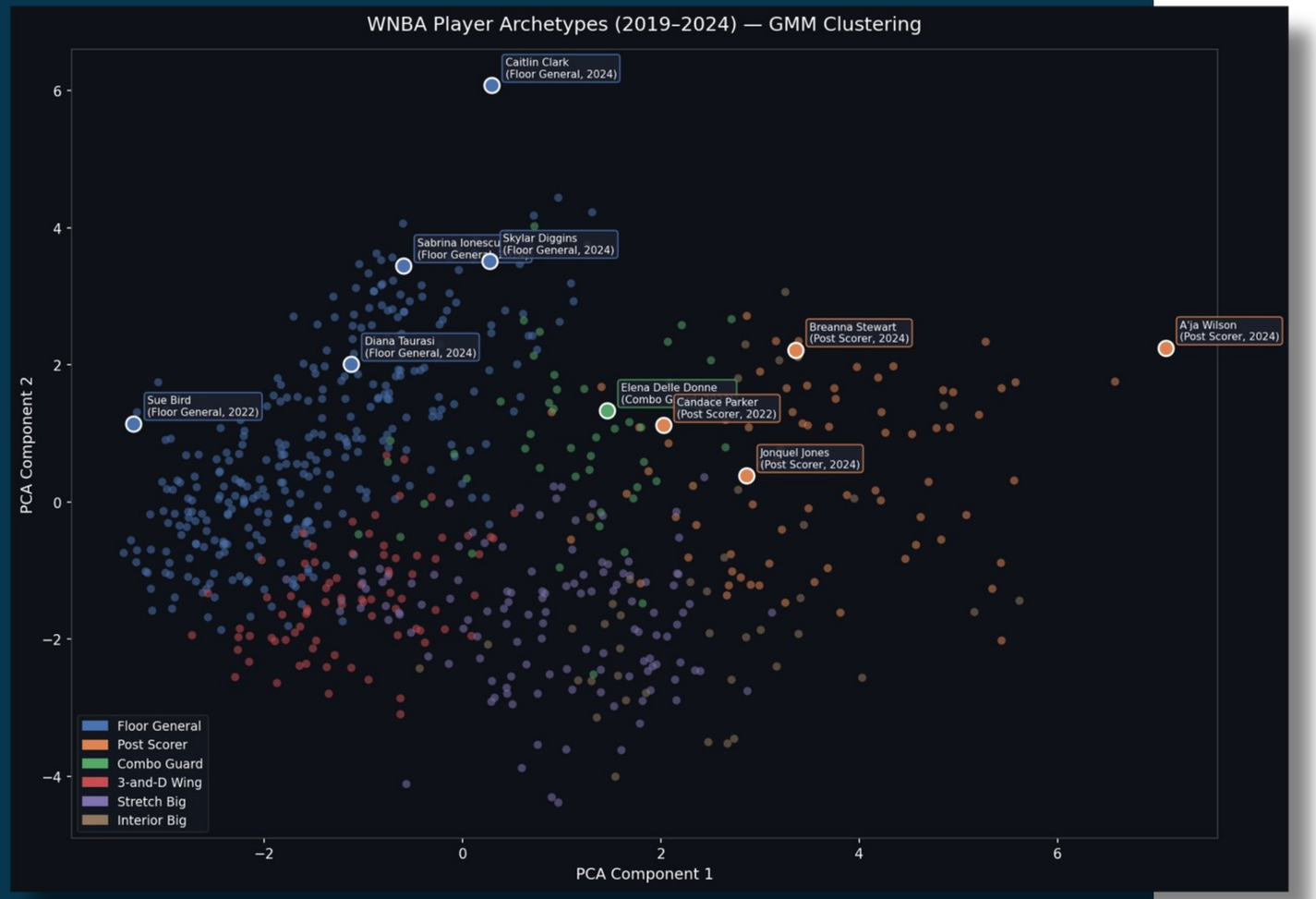
RESEARCH QUESTIONS

Can college women's basketball statistics reliably predict WNBA career success?

Can team-specific needs be quantified to produce actionable draft recommendations?



ARCHETYPE CLASSIFICATION



- WNBA player seasons (2019–2024) clustered into 6 role archetypes via Gaussian Mixture Model

- GMM-assigned archetype labels serve as ground-truth targets for supervised classification

- Logistic regression trained to identify which NCAA women's basketball statistics predict each WNBA archetype

WNBA READINESS SCORE (XGBOOST)

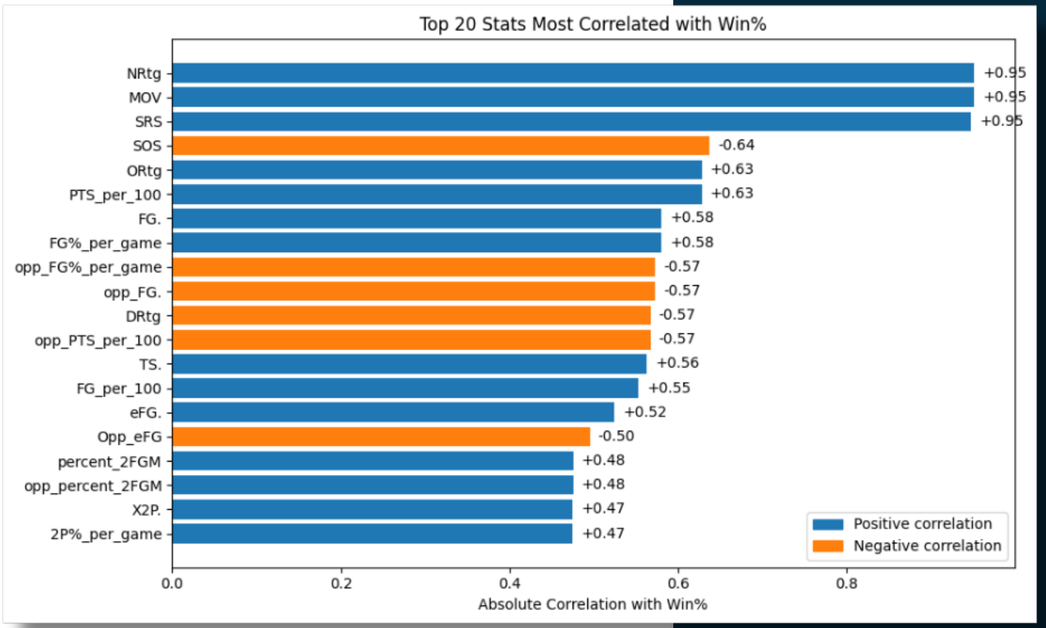
Training Target: 0.30×WS/40 +0.30×BPM + 0.20×PER +0.20×TS%

Features :

- Scoring & efficiency
- Shooting profile
- Playmaking
- Rebounding
- Defense
- Advanced
- Context
- Physicals

TEAM FIT SCORE

- Analyzed which stats are most important for winning
- Calculate stat deficit weighted by importance
- Fit = deficit × weighted sum of NCAA proxy z-scores
- Sum across all team needs



FINAL OUTPUT

- Total = 0.55 × readiness + 0.45 × fit

